



# circularity at skullspace

*a proposal for an events subcommittee · member meeting handout*

## WHY

we throw out a lot of stuff that still works, almost works, or could be reworked into something that works. the numbers in canada:

- **e-waste:** ~954,000 tonnes generated in 2020, projected to hit ~1.2 million tonnes by 2030 (~31.5 kg per person per year)
- **textiles:** a 2023 university of waterloo study put canadian textile disposal at ~500 million kg per year, with ~85% of that landfilled
- **average household:** roughly 81 lb (37 kg) of textiles tossed per person per year

at the same time, the legal landscape just shifted. on **november 7, 2024**, bills **C-244** and **C-294** received royal assent. C-244 amends the copyright act to legalize circumventing digital locks (TPMs) for diagnosis, maintenance, and repair; C-294 does the same for interoperability. these are canada's first decisive federal moves on right to repair.

quebec went further: **bill 29** (planned obsolescence / right to repair) had its core provisions come into force **october 5, 2025**, requiring manufacturers to disclose parts and repair availability and prohibiting techniques that hinder repair.

translation: the legal cover for community-scale repair just got real, and demand for places to learn how is wide open.

skullspace already has the space, the tools, and the people. the marginal cost of running circular events here is low. the value to the community is high.

## WHAT

**mission:** use skullspace's space, tools, and expertise to extend the useful life of stuff and reduce friction on community-scale reuse, repair, and barter.

**scope:** electronic and textile waste (to start).

**goals:**

- **must have** — reduce waste through hands-on repair, parts harvesting, and rerouting usable materials
- **should have** — equip people with the skills and tools to maintain ownership over what they buy; anti-consumerist mutual aid via circular economics
- **nice to have** — drive engagement, visibility, and (eventually) memberships for skullspace

this is framed as political, environmental mutual aid. peer skill-share with snacks, not service delivery.

## WHAT THE EVENTS LOOK LIKE

**low-effort — donations, swaps, drop-offs we could start basically now:**

- **clothing swap:** bring stuff, take stuff. unsold surplus routed to a local diversion partner.
- **vape recycling bin:** collection at evening events (rave nights, etc.); routed to mother earth recycling or another appropriate hazmat stream.
- **laptop trade-in tickets:** discounted entry to a skullspace event in exchange for old laptops, routed to **computers for schools manitoba** (refurbishes ~5,000 machines/year, diverts ~500,000 lb of e-waste annually) or **mother earth recycling** (indigenous-owned, EPRA-certified e-waste depot).
- **standing e-waste collection point:** small drop-off station at the space, periodic runs to mother earth recycling.

**longer-term — hands-on / instructional events that need supplies, instructors, and planning:**

- **drop-in repair night:** bring electronics. short walk-through to start: finding service manuals, what tools to grab, how to isolate a fault, when to call it, what to scavenge. needs scheduled tool/bench time and at least one skilled facilitator per session.
- **phone repair clinic:** bulk repair kits, fixed entry fee for non-members, free for members; instructor honoraria.
- **sewing / textile repair drop-in:** machines, notions, basic instruction. would need to scrounge or buy a couple of machines.
- **cable-making workshop:** ethernet, patch cords. test old cables, recycle the dead ones.
- **standing partnerships** with local diversion orgs (computers for schools manitoba, mother earth recycling, the WRENCH for bikes).
- **ongoing inventory** of donated tools and parts available to all members.

## THE MODEL ISN'T NOVEL — THAT'S THE POINT

we'd be one node in a growing canadian network. as of october 2025, repair café international counts >3,800 active repair cafés worldwide. **repair café toronto** has been running since 2013, partnered with the toronto tool library, the city of toronto's circular economy program, and toronto public library. **vancouver** runs repair cafés through SPEC and a free swap toolkit out of the city government. the playbook is well-trodden.

## THE ASK

1. **ORGANIZING COMMITTEE** — *who wants in?* roles/duties: session support (tools, general help during events), transport (donation pickups/dropoffs), event coordination & promotion (scheduling, social, signage), admin (inventory, supply ordering, basic event accounting), skullspace liaison (status report at member meetings).
2. **EXISTING PROCESS** — *what's skullspace's path for spinning up an initiative like this?* committee charter, motion, budget request — what's the right path? if there isn't a defined one, what would the board want to see from us?
3. **INITIAL BUDGET** — *what can we run for free vs. what needs investment?* the low-effort events (swaps, drop-offs, trade-in tickets) can run at essentially zero cost. anything supply-dependent (sewing machines, phone repair kits, instructor honoraria) needs either a starting budget, a fundraiser, or sponsor contributions. open to whatever makes sense.
4. **STORAGE & INVENTORY** — *where does the accumulated stuff live?* tools and donated materials need somewhere to live between sessions, possibly with offsite transport for oversized items. would value member input on what skullspace can absorb.

***start small. build engagement and awareness. fundraise toward more ambitious programming as we go.***

### SAFETY & COMPLIANCE

many of these events involve damaged electronics, lithium batteries, soldering, sewing equipment, and tools that carry real risk. before any hands-on programming launches, the committee will need to perform a serious hazard assessment per event type, establish operational safety policy (PPE, workspace prep, hazmat disposal), confirm first aid coverage, and verify compliance with skullspace's existing rules and any applicable provincial / municipal requirements.

## TODO

- ☒ present overview at general assembly 04/28
- ☐ answer questions and gather feedback
- ☐ establish interest in hosting this initiative from skullspace members
- ☐ create a circularity channel in skullspace discord
- ☐ take emails from interested volunteers ↓



wait, why are you scanning a random hacker QR code?  
to view this document, including references and additional reading, visit [yetanotherkiki.github.io/circularity](https://yetanotherkiki.github.io/circularity)

**confidence notes:** legislative facts (bill numbers, royal assent dates, in-force dates) are well-sourced. waste statistics are from credible sources but estimates vary across studies and methodologies — figures here are representative rather than definitive. the suggested partner organizations are real but no contact has been made; their willingness to participate is unverified.